

INTERMENT CAMP

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PREVIEW ONLY

CUT TO:

IN BLACK AND WHITE:

EXT. HIROSHIMA SKY -- DAY

Old footage of a CARGO PLANE as it flies through the air. The hull doors underneath begin to close, and--

An ATOMIC BOMB explodes over Hiroshima. The camera footage is shaky. The destruction is clear.

SUPER: **LITTLE BOY, AUGUST 6, 1945 8:15AM (15 KILOTONS)**

EXT. NAGASAKI SKY -- DAY

Another plane soars through the air, right above--

An ORB of RADIATION as it plumes into the sky. It balloons into a TOXIC MUSHROOM CLOUD over the dying city.

SUPER: **FAT MAN, AUGUST 9, 1945 11:02AM (20 KILOTONS)**

EXT. SKY -- NIGHT

FIREWORKS explode in the cloudless night sky.

EXT. CAMPGROUNDS -- SAME TIME

WHITE GUARDS raise whiskey bottles and fists as they SHOUT and CHEER.

Forlorn Japanese faces gaze up at the exploding fireworks. One LIGHTS up the face of young 8-year-old JENNY SAITO. A free-spirited child full of wonder and imagination.

JENNY

Fireworks! Mama, [did we win?]

[*Note: all Japanese dialogue in brackets.]

Beside Jenny are her middle-aged mother, two morose young adult men, and a young adult woman. A mix of despondent faces and heavy tears. We'll learn more about them soon.

EXT. MAIN ENTRANCE -- DAY

A lone TOWER GUARD patrols a single TOWER nearby.

Little Jenny runs toward it. Clutched in her hand is a SLIP OF PAPER.

SUPER: Camp Tulelake, Northern California, Two Months Later

The Tower Guard recognizes her. He climbs down.

She hands him the piece of PAPER. He takes it. Reads it. Pockets the slip.

TOWER GUARD
If you ain't back in four hours,
you're sleeping outside tonight.

JENNY
Just throw me a blanket.

TOWER GUARD
These lands are dangerous, little
Jenny. Mountain lions, coyotes, the
wilderness.

JENNY
I'll take my chances.

The Tower Guard shrugs. He warned her.

MOMENTS LATER

The GATES part open. Jenny darts through.

EXT. DRYLANDS -- DAY

Arid grass and sun-caked dirt. A DIRT ROAD carves a path up to the top of a pointy rock summit.

Jenny runs up the path, all smiles, with the open fields and boundless sky around her.

She seems content. Then--

A shrub BRISTLES nearby. Jenny quickly freezes.

From a nearby shrub, something moves again.

Jenny is fiercely on guard. Only to see--

A BLACK CAT wander out. Jenny recognizes them.

JENNY
Hi, Mooney. I missed you.

MOONEY the cat rubs up against Jenny. Jenny picks them up and plays with them a bit. Then, she sets Mooney down. Mooney runs off. Jenny follows.

EXT. UPHILL PATH -- DAY

Jenny and Mooney run up a sloped hill, leaving a trail of dust in their wake.

EXT. CASTLE ROCK SUMMIT -- DAY

Jenny reaches the summit with an extra pep in her step. Mooney sprints ahead, toward--

A LARGE CROSS. Jenny makes her way toward it.

Once she reaches the cross, she closes her eyes, presses both hands together in prayer.

JENNY

I'm sorry, God. I signed the
permission slip. Amen.

Mooney lingers by the overlook. VAST MOUNTAINS stretch in the distance with summit caps that breach the summer sky.

And down below--CAMP TULE LAKE. More than a square mile of grid-like buildings, people, military vehicles, all surrounded by barbed-wire fence. Guard posts are placed at repeating intervals, with guns pointed into the camp.